

LOOK OUT FOR...



IRFAN YADWAD

The Goa-born player **(in blue)** began his Indian top-flight journey in the 2023-24 season but remained a relatively unknown figure. However, in the ongoing 2024-25 season, he has grabbed the spotlight. Playing for Chennaiyin FC, Yadwad has registered three goals and two assists in 14 appearances. His brilliant form earned him his maiden national team call-up, and he made his India debut in an international friendly against Malaysia.

Standing at 6ft, Irfan's blistering pace and versatility in the forward line make him an asset for coaches. His speed and a penchant for making excellent runs behind the defence — all crucial qualities in an attacker. In terms of creativity, he also demonstrates an ability to deliver incisive passes.

With the Indian football team's forward line desperately craving quality players, Irfan has the potential to become the next big thing in Indian football and cement a permanent place in the Blue Tigers' starting XI.